Westbrook Planning Board

~ Planning Board Meeting ~

Date: Tuesday, June 2, 2026
Time: 7:00 PM
Location: Westbrook High School (Room 114), 125 Stroudwater St. (Hybrid via Zoom)
Video: https://vimeo.com/1197883329
Packet: https://www.westbrookmaine.gov/AgendaCenter/ViewFile/Agenda/_06022026-1009

Timestamps below are clickable [0:00]-style links — they jump straight to that moment in the video.

This summary highlights the meeting's key discussions and decisions, with direct quotes and timestamps for verification — it is not a substitute for watching the full meeting. *This was an exceptionally long meeting (nearly 3.5 hours, seven substantive items) with heavy public turnout; summarization necessarily condenses and selects more than usual, especially in the public comment sections. For complete context, nuance, and anything not covered here, watch the full video at the link above. (Produced by: WestbrookCurrents.com)*

Unofficial summary. *This is produced by Westbrook Currents, an independent site — not the City of Westbrook — and may contain mistakes. For the official record, see the City's approved minutes and the meeting video.*

I. Roll Call & Announcements

Roll Call & Agenda Change [0:03]

Discussion Summary

Chair Larry McWilliams announced that 500 Spring Street, listed on the printed agenda, would instead be heard June 16 given tonight's heavy workload. Roll call: eight of nine seated members present (McWilliams, Lucas Schrage, Robin Tannenbaum, Kevin Price, Nancy Litrocapes, Jason Frazier, Karen Axelson, and Vice Chair John Turcotte); Oriana Farnham absent. No minutes were on the agenda.

Key Decisions

✓ **Quorum established.**

Action Items

None.

25-000402 — Site Plan Amendment Extension — 619 Bridgton Rd., Cloutier Properties [1:35]

Discussion Summary

The applicant, requesting a one-year extension to a previously amended site plan, did not appear. Staff indicated outreach had been made about a possible June 16 appearance.

Key Decisions

✓ **Deferred — not reviewed tonight.**

Action Items

None.

Regular Business

25-000624 — Site Plan, Subdivision, Village Review — 688–712 Main St., Ryan Le [2:28]

Discussion Summary

Andy Morrill (BH2M) reported on three issues flagged at a November 2025 review: the sewer was rerouted entirely through the 712 Main Street parcel via a grinder pump; Building A was pulled back to a 12.5-foot setback from a shared retaining wall, eliminating the need for a maintenance easement an abutter had declined to grant; and stormwater was redesigned with expanded retention and an upstream-watershed bypass. Abutter Gary Minujian (702 Main St.) spoke against the project, citing lost backyard privacy and the declined easement request. Staff confirmed the one-space-per-unit parking meets the City Center District standard. Vice Chair John Turcotte asked about buffering given a roughly 40-foot grade difference to abutting yards; a 9-foot retaining wall with a wood guardrail serves as the primary buffer.

Key Decisions

✓ Approved by unanimous roll call, 7–0 (Robin Tannenbaum recused), moved by John Turcotte, seconded by Kevin Price.

Action Items

None.

25-001113 — Site Plan — 405 Bridgton Rd., Vaughn Dibiase [20:06]

Discussion Summary

Dustin Roma (DM Roma Consulting Engineers) presented a 7,500-sq-ft, five-bay multi-tenant “service business” building with a single access point designed to prevent left turns exiting onto Bridgton Road, no outdoor material storage, and downcast building-mounted lighting. Staff required final plans to commit to whether a sprinkler system will be installed before signature. Abutters Pauline and Paul Barrows (409 Bridgton Rd.) raised a deeded drainage easement they hold across the property and questioned the parking count and sign placement near their driveway sightline; the applicant confirmed a culvert will intercept drainage at its current entry point with a slow-release design, and the sign will sit well back of their driveway. Chair McWilliams praised the traffic study (citing a 1.43% corridor traffic increase, 2016–2022) and the single-access design.

Key Decisions

✓ Approved by unanimous roll call, 8–0.

Action Items

None.

26-000404 — Subdivision Amendment — Rock Row South Campus [56:05]

Discussion Summary

Ian McKim (Jones & Beach Engineers) presented a third amendment reconfiguring lot lines across several Phase 3 parcels to separate ownership/responsibility under a master condominium/cross-easement agreement. Staff noted a November 2025 amendment to this subdivision was never finalized with Portland and voided, so this amendment builds on the November 2024-approved baseline; each lot still requires its own site plan review. The board granted a waiver extending the subdivision-plan recording deadline to 150 days (a prior joint-meeting waiver with Portland carries over).

Key Decisions

✓ Approved by unanimous roll call, 8–0, moved by Nancy Litrocapes, seconded by Lucas Schrage.

Action Items

None.

Workshop — Rock Row Phase 3 Building V, Element Hotel (26-000402)

5-Story, 119-Room Element by Marriott with Ground-Floor Retail [1:08:16]

Discussion Summary

Ian McKim introduced Tom Dever and Greg Del Niro of Dever Architects presenting a 5-story, 119-room Element by Marriott hotel (an extended-stay, sustainability-branded line, roughly 70% full-kitchen units) with ground-floor restaurant/retail, near Nason's Brook across Quarry Drive from the garage/residential buildings reviewed at the prior meeting. The building includes a pass-through “paseo” courtyard and relies on the adjacent parking garage for guest parking via a planned cross-easement; aluminum composite panel facades in gray, white, and wood tones are proposed, with ground-floor brick. No public comment.

Board reaction was strongly positive. Member Jason Frazier asked for more landscape-berming detail and example renderings. Vice Chair John Turcotte praised the team for showing the building in context with its neighbors for the first time and asked for similarly contextual views going forward. Member Robin Tannenbaum, initially disoriented by inconsistent plan orientations, asked for a standard north arrow in future submissions and confirmed there is no conference/banquet space. Member Kevin Price asked how facade consistency would be maintained once retail tenants are chosen; the team explained master developer Waterstone will build out and lease the ground-floor shell directly using a consistent architectural “frame.”

Key Decisions

✓ No vote — workshop item.

Action Items

None.

Point/Counterpoint — Millbrook Estates: Affordable Housing Need vs. Neighborhood Scale (26-000401)

[1:49:55] Tyler Nord (President, Westbrook Development Corporation) reintroduced a project first approved for a contract zone amendment and sketch plan in 2024 that stalled when state funding cycles changed; the design is unchanged. Proposal: two 36-unit, three-story affordable apartment buildings (LIHTC-funded, 50–60% area median income, no age restriction) on two vacant lots at the existing 138-unit Millbrook Estates complex, roughly two-thirds of which is already protected open space via a Presumpscot Regional Land Trust partnership. Nord cited statewide data (roughly 25,000 affordable units needed by 2030, only 2,000–3,000 built so far) and estimated about 40% of current Westbrook residents income-qualify for this project. Architects described wraparound porches, gabled (not flat) roofs stepping down toward the rear, and retained street trees intended to soften the buildings' scale.

The critical case

> *“With the height and placement of these buildings, they want to change the area from suburban to urban... Will Westbrook look back on this and wish it had stayed with the original intent?”*

— Beth Paulson-Omstead, 245 Methodist Rd. (public comment) [2:12:35]

Paulson-Omstead questioned Westbrook Development Corporation's growth pace and motives, and asked whether original commitments made to the neighborhood about building scale when Millbrook was first built had been reviewed. Staff (Rebecca Spitella) responded that roughly 25% of projects approved by this board over the past five to ten years have been affordable housing developments, and confirmed no zoning change is being requested.

Board reaction — notably split

Member Kevin Price was strongly supportive, calling the project “a testament to what you can do” and praising its integration with the land trust green space. Vice Chair John Turcotte asked staff to verify whether the original 2024 approval included conditions restricting use of these lots, and requested additional parking buffering. Member Jason Frazier took a middle position, supporting the need in principle but asking how the height gap to smaller homes across the street could be visually bridged.

> *“I can't imagine a three-story that close to the road with the gable. It'd be one thing if it was a flat roof and not peaking so high, because it's gonna be very towering.”*

— Chair Larry McWilliams [2:23:43]

Key Decisions

No vote — workshop item. The applicant hopes to return with a final application within a couple of months, racing a Maine Housing funding cycle (application this fall, award decision around November 2026).

Point/Counterpoint — 955 Bridgton Rd.: New Density vs. Existing Drainage & Traffic (26-000403)

[2:34:45] Dustin Roma presented a conceptual plan for roughly 10 duplex (condo-for-sale) buildings totaling 20–26 units (pending formal wetland delineation) on a 10-acre, legally non-conforming parcel accessed via a rebuilt private driveway. The existing home and barn would be demolished; a wooded buffer along the Willow Drive property line would be retained. The primary open issue is driveway/entrance permitting, since Route 302 here is treated as a mobility corridor/arterial inside the City's “urban compact.”

Neighbors turned out in large numbers with overlapping concerns, centrally pre-existing drainage problems and Route 302 traffic safety that long predate this project. Several residents described chronic flooding and water crossing multiple properties via culverts that feed the Millbrook watershed, and described Route 302 as dangerously fast with a history of collisions and near-misses turning onto or off the road.

> *“The traffic... Friday nights in the summer, we can't even get out of our road. I've sat there fifteen minutes or so just trying to get out.”*

— Ann Sturgeon, 41 Willow Drive (public comment) [2:50:29]

Staff (Rebecca Spitella) gave an extended process explainer: this is a conceptual workshop stage only; the unit-count range will be fixed once a wetland delineation determines buildable area; “driveway” terminology refers to legal frontage status, not literal width (it will be rebuilt to private-way standards with verified

emergency-vehicle turning templates); and a Westbrook police officer is currently issuing the second-highest number of speeding tickets statewide in an effort to address Route 302 speeding broadly. Chair McWilliams asked about buffering options (no fence is permitted under the adjacent HOA's covenant) and the driveway's raised grade as a possible icy-conditions hazard, and floated a future board site walk once the design is more finalized, which the applicant and staff agreed to coordinate.

Key Decisions

No vote — workshop item.

How this was made

This summary was produced from the meeting video (linked above, hosted on the City's Vimeo showcase). The audio was transcribed with AI-assisted speech-to-text and speaker identification. This process cross-checked names against the official Planning Board roster, attributed speakers from context (introductions, roll-call order, direct address by the Chair) rather than the raw diarization labels alone, and drafted this summary and the quoted excerpts. Quotes are lightly cleaned of filler words/false starts but not reworded. Review tier: Not reviewed.

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